

What Video 1 Should Actually Be

Sleep channel · decision report · 4 Sep 2026 · built on the live YouTube pull from blissolicpy.github.io/sleep-channel-report

THE RECOMMENDATION

Build something, in Minecraft, with a criminal name on it. Talk over the top.

Lead pick: **fall asleep while we build a prison in minecraft**. Two hours fifteen, lowercase title, two separate mic tracks, in-game music off. The deed goes in the title; the conversation is what the video actually is. That is the exact split the fastest channel in this niche uses.

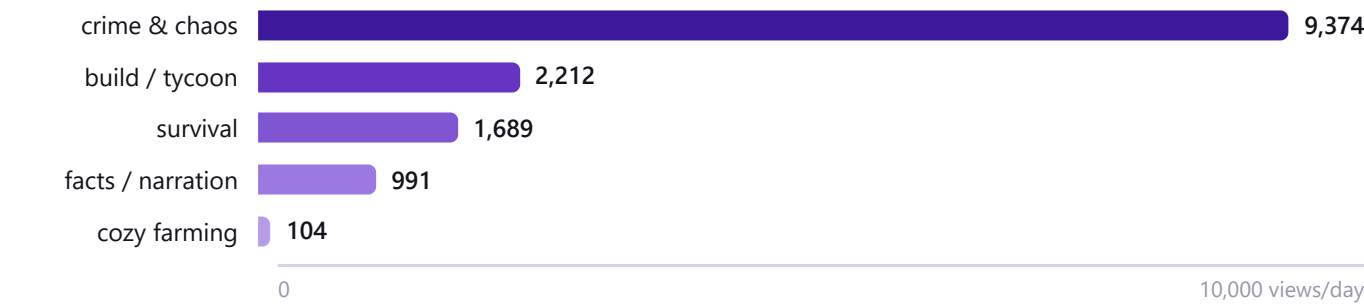
Why “build with a crime name” and not the obvious things

The top performers in this format are not doing crimes. They are doing **builds with a crime name attached**. sleepyslorgs — 154k subs, entire catalogue posted inside 12 months — runs *Build a Nuclear Bomb in My Garden, Worsen the Housing Crisis, Operate Heavy Artillery*. That last one did **602,431 views in 5 days = 120,486 views/day**, the fastest single video in the whole dataset.

The joke is the title. The video is calm. That is the entire trick, and it is what makes the format work: the title has to promise something, the footage has to be boring enough to sleep through, and a build satisfies both at once. Actual crime runs out in twenty minutes. A build fills two hours without you having to invent anything.

Median views per day, by what the video actually does

Live pull, 4 Sep 2026. Views/day, not raw views — raw views reward old videos and hide what is working now.



Crime and chaos beats cozy farming by **90×**. This is the single biggest lever in the format and it is entirely decided by what you name the video.

The evidence, ranked by how much I would trust it

FINDING	THE NUMBER	STRENGTH
Crime/chaos activity beats everything	9,374 v/day vs 104	Strong — two independent runs, both put it first
2h–2h30 is the correct length	1,341 v/day	Strong — 163 at 5h+, ~2 under 1h
Open-ended chat fails	35 v/day vs 1,084	Strong — same channel, same audience, so it is a real control
A brand-new channel can still break in	17 → 17,000 subs in ~1 week	Strong — Kindly Sleepin', Aug 2026, off one video

FINDING	THE NUMBER	STRENGTH
Subscriber count barely matters	0.08 vs 96 views/sub	Strong — 22.6M-sub channel vs a 1,800-sub one
Silence outperforms talking	9.2×	Solid but single-source — one 307k channel running both
Lowercase titles do better	2.46×	Correlation only — cheap to obey, so obey it
Where Minecraft itself ranks	mid vs 4,591 v/day	Weakest link — the two runs genuinely disagree

THE HONEST GAP

Everything above is measured across the niche. What I do **not** have is a clean read on Minecraft-specific crime/build titles, because the two sampling runs put Minecraft in different places (mid-table in one, second at 4,591 views/day in the other). The activity finding is solid; “therefore do it in Minecraft” is a judgement call on top of it, made because Minecraft is the engine you already own and can actually operate for two hours.

What not to do — and it is what you were about to do

The two worst-performing sub-genres in the whole sweep, in order:

- **Story-reading over Minecraft** — worst, median 9,436 views.
- **Parkour as wallpaper** — second worst, median 14,597 views.

The original plan — parkour in the background while you talk about superheroes — is both of those at once. That is not a reason to bin the recording; it is a reason not to make it video 1. The fix is not to talk less. It is to **put a deed in the title** so the video has a shape, and to make the talk **structured and finishable** rather than open-ended.

THE ONE-LINE RULE

Never title it “talk about X”. Use a verb that promises a result — **settle, rank, fix, decide, ruin, build, rob, evict**. Down To Sleep proved the cost on their own channel: open-ended *Ask Me Anything* did **35 views/day** against **284** and **1,084** for their structured videos. Same channel. Same subscribers. 8–31× worse.

The three options for video 1

PICK THIS ONE

fall asleep while we build a prison in minecraft

- ACTIVITY** Build a prison. Cell blocks, yard, walls, watchtowers. Genuinely fills 2h15 without a plan, and the footage is placing blocks — about as calm as footage gets.
- TALK** Every time each of you has been in trouble, numbered and counted down. Personal stories was the third-best bucket at **2,675 views/day**, and numbering it is what stops it becoming the AMA failure.
- WHY** Crime register in the title, build-tycoon activity underneath — the top two buckets combined. The prison also gives the talk its theme for free, so it never sounds like a podcast bolted onto random footage.

OPTION 2

fall asleep while we evict an entire village

- ACTIVITY** Clear a village and rebuild it worse. Demolition then construction, so the pacing changes halfway through on its own.
- TALK** Ranked worst places you have lived, worst neighbours, worst landlords.
- WHY** The closest structural clone of *Worsen the Housing Crisis* in the reference set. Note it does not say Minecraft — search finds that anyway and the characters are better spent on the deed.

OPTION 3

fall asleep while we build a nuclear bunker

- ACTIVITY** Dig down, build out. Repetitive, quiet, visually dark — which suits a sleep video better than a bright overworld.
- TALK** End-of-the-world hypotheticals. Structured, endless, and low-stakes enough to drift off inside.
- WHY** Direct analogue of sleepyslorgs' *Build a Nuclear Bomb in My Garden*. Lowest-risk of the three because digging is the calmest footage available.

The alternative bet, if you will play something other than Minecraft

Satisfying cleaning — PowerWash Simulator and its neighbours. This has the strongest evidence in the entire report for a channel starting from zero:

- **Kindly Sleepin' went from 17 to about 17,000 subscribers in roughly a week**, August 2026, off a single video.
- **Kindly Keyin sits on 609 subscribers doing 7,063 views/day.** That is a channel smaller than yours will be next week, out-performing channels a thousand times its size.
- KozyKanz, 11.3k subs, ~3,000 views/day.

Nothing else in the sweep shows a channel that small moving that fast. If the two of you are willing to play something other than Minecraft, this is where the numbers point hardest. The trade-off is that it is a newer, thinner shelf and you would be guessing at the title register rather than copying a proven one.

Title mechanics — free multipliers, obey all of them

DO / DON'T	EFFECT	NOTE
Write it all lowercase	2.46×	Correlation, but it costs nothing
The word "rain", where honest	2.11×	Only if there is actually rain
Writing the word "sleep" or "relaxing"	0.40–0.54×	Halves you. The format already says it
"10 Hours" / Title Case	0.40–0.54×	Same penalty band
Naming the deed, not the game	2,797 v/day	"Build An Arctic Research Base" vs a generic Minecraft title

Production spec — the things you cannot fix afterwards

- **2h–2h30.** Median 1,341 views/day in that band. Under an hour is dead: **~2 views/day.**
- **Two separate microphone tracks.** A duo needs each voice hard-limited independently, or one of you laughing spikes over the other and wakes the listener. This is decided at record time and nowhere else.
- **In-game music off.** Warner Chappell filed false Content ID claims on C418 tracks in Oct 2024 and hit Mumbo Jumbo. Turning the music off removes the risk entirely.
- **Energy decays on purpose.** Arguments and picks in the first half, storytelling in the second. Debate wakes people; narration does not.
- **Never address the listener's state.** No "are you still awake".
- **State the premise in the first 30 seconds, then stop.** No channel pitch, no sub beg at the front, quiet sign-off with no outro music.

THE TWO RISKS YOU ARE TAKING KNOWINGLY

1. Nobody has built a channel around two people in this format. The duo evidence is collabs between two established solo creators (MadMorph × Down To Sleep: 2,713 / 746 / 321 views/day against ~912 solo) — parity, not a penalty. But Down To Sleep has not uploaded since **16 Nov 2025**, so it is not an ongoing model. **2. Silence beats talking by 9.2×** on the one channel that runs both formats to the same 307k subscribers (no-commentary median 257,000 views vs 28,000 narrated). A voiced duo costs reach in the short term and buys an actual audience in the long term. Take that trade deliberately, not by accident.

What success looks like

The YouTube Partner Programme bar **doubles on 1 Feb 2027** — 4,000 to 8,000 watch hours. At 2-hour videos and 35% retention you need roughly **5,700 total views** to clear the current bar. One video in the crime/chaos band at the niche median would do it on its own. That is the strongest argument for starting now rather than after another month of research.

Data live-pulled 4 Sep 2026 via yt-dlp, no API key · full reports at blissolicpy.github.io/sleep-channel-report/ · views/day used throughout, never raw views